

Playstation Store in India

Indian PS owners will now get access to downloadable content of the PS Store with an annual charge of Rs. 2850 for PS Plus program

F1 2010

By Abhinav Lal

F1 2010 certainly had a lot to live

up to - being the first FIA licensed game to hit the PC

in 8 years. It is also the first F1 title to hit the Xbox 360, and is developed by Codemasters, the guys who brought us Dirt (Colin McRae) and Race Driver.

F1 2010 has four main game modes: Career, Grand Prix, Time Trial and Multi-player. Career is your season, with your player rising up the ranks, starting with one of the lower-ranked teams, based on player performance and contract offers. Grand Prix is the equivalent of Quick Race, allowing you to play as any of the drivers for any of the teams, on any of the circuits.

If you are daunted by having to race all 59 laps of Qatar when you play, you'd be pleased to know the minimum setting is 20% of the Race Weekend, which can be amped up depending on just how many hand-aching minutes you want to spend on track. This would get you approximately 10 laps out of 60, an hour-long practice session, and twenty minutes of qualifying.

As far as graphics go, the game is hardly stunning, but that's not for lack of realism, but more because it's almost realistically boring enough not to stun you. You've got to appreciate the overall nary-a-foot-long look though. Rain is when you truly see the finer touches to the experi-

ence, with the inside and roof camera views rather beautifully obscured - worst in the spray of a car ahead of you. All this makes for some serious load times, even on a rather well-endowed system. However, once race/qualifying/practice sessions are loaded, there are no load times anywhere else.

The plethora of view options is also very satisfying, and very Codemasters, with three outside views, one cockpit view, one bumper view, and one roof view. Sitting inside the cockpit, with the low height giving you a seriously close horizon, is something you want the most of when you have to spot the next corner at 280km per hour.

On the simulation front, F1 2010 follows much of Codemasters' previously established formulas, where controls and physics are accurate enough not to feel arcade-like, yet, are not as unforgiving as you know the real deal would be, especially in the rain. More proof of this being a Codemasters' game comes from the inclusion of Flashbacks, which is a useful feature that sets back the clock on your accidents/errors a limited number of times depending on your difficulty



settings. This really shows its worth in F1 2010, where you will be very grateful for its presence if you spin out on Lap 9/10.

Tweaking stuff in the paddock is part of the fun. So while you can upgrade your car over the course of the season, you can also mess with a nicely detailed list of performance settings, from engine to gearbox to balance to tyres.

Multiplayer is surprisingly easy to setup and fun, requiring just a Windows Live ID, and is rather fast even on a low/medium broadband connection. You can also set up a custom multiplayer Grand Prix season, as well as of course, LAN gaming.

Overall it's a worthy game to have mastered. It will also last you a while, with quite a few hours for the learning curve, and then an entire season to finish, more contract offers and teams to join, multiplayer gaming, and beating your own best times in Time Trial. All in all, at Rs. 999 for the PC, F1 2010 is definitely a must have for F1 fans